

RTAM FOUNDATION — BRAND BOOK

ऋतम् फाउंडेशन • RTAM Foundation

I • PHILOSOPHY

R̥tam (ऋतम्) names the cosmic order that holds — the structuring principle that turns chaos into form, season into return, breath into measure. It is the oldest word the Vedic tradition has for *truth* in the sense of *the way things are*. The foundation takes its name from that word, and its identity from a single mark: a dot beneath the letter R.

The dot is the *bindu* — root, seed, source, the point from which form arises. In the wordmark it sits beneath the R as the diacritic of *r̥*. It is the brand signature. Without it the wordmark reads "RTAM"; with it the wordmark reads "R̥TAM" — and the foundation's whole claim is in that subtraction and return.

The visual system that follows is built to keep that mark intentional at every scale.

2 · NAMES

FORM	USE
ṚTAM Foundation	Primary written form in Latin-script contexts. Always with the dot under R when typeset; RTAM Foundation is the public ASCII fallback.
ऋतम् फाउंडेशन	Common-register Devanagari. Use in bilingual lockups, Hindi-speaking audiences, signage.
ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान	Pure-Sanskritic Devanagari (<i>pratiṣṭhāna</i> — "established institution"). For scholarly, sacred, or trust-deed contexts.
Rtambhareshvara Mandir	The temple. Latin form for physical signage and donor materials.
ऋतम्भरेश्वर मंदिर	The temple, Devanagari. Always present in the temple lockup.

3 · THE LOGO SYSTEM

The kit has **one primary**, **two icons**, **four lockups**, and **one secondary seal**. They do not share visual chrome; what they share is the bindu and the typographic family.

3.1 PRIMARY WORDMARK

The wordmark is the foundation's voice in public. Five variants:

FILE	USE
<code>rtam-wordmark-sacred-RTAM-dot.svg</code>	Canonical. Charcoal letters, gold bindu.
<code>rtam-wordmark-gold.svg</code>	All-gold. For sacred contexts, embossed printing, dark backgrounds where gold + charcoal won't show.
<code>rtam-wordmark-black.svg</code>	All-black. For pure-black reproduction (single-color printing, fax, microform).
<code>rtam-wordmark-white.svg</code>	All-ivory on a baked charcoal ground (so the file is visible when opened standalone). To overlay the ivory mark on indigo or a photograph, remove the first <code><rect></code> element.
<code>rtam-wordmark-public-RTAM.svg</code>	ASCII-only, no bindu. Use only when the bindu cannot be reliably reproduced (low-resolution sign vinyl, embroidered shirts under 6 cm wide).

The bindu is **drawn as a separate** `<circle>` in every SVG. It is not a Unicode combining mark. This is deliberate: the bindu must remain exact in size and position across every reproduction surface.

3.2 R-MONOGRAM

A square mark of the bare R with the bindu beneath, in two families:

- **Open form** — gold / black / ivory variants for plain-background contexts.
- **Circle-enclosed** — gold ring or all-charcoal, for app icons, social avatars, and any context where the mark needs to claim its own visual territory.

Plus `favicon.svg` (32 viewBox) for browser tabs. The favicon scales cleanly to **64 px**; above that, switch to the full R-monogram SVG, because the bindu spacing was tuned for the favicon's small size and visibly detaches at 8× scale.

3.3 DEVANAGARI ऀ MONOGRAM

The Devanagari letter ऀ (ऀ) is itself the bindu's complement — the glyph carries the sacred mark intrinsically. The ऀ monogram therefore has **no separate dot**. It is the only icon in the system without one, and that absence is the point.

Four variants: gold / black / ivory / circle-enclosed.

3.4 LOCKUPS

FILE	USE
<code>rtam-bilingual-foundation.svg</code>	Common-register: ṚTAM Foundation over ऋतम् फाउंडेशन. Default bilingual.
<code>rtam-sanskritic-pratishthan.svg</code>	Pure-Sanskritic: ṚTAM Foundation over ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान. Scholarly / sacred.
<code>rtambhareshvara-mandir-lockup.svg</code>	Temple name, both scripts. Wider viewBox (1280) to fit the longest name.
<code>donation-lockup.svg</code>	Wordmark + thin gold rule + a single quiet stone-gray line. Header, not CTA.

3.5 SECONDARY SEAL

The 12-medallion seal: one outer ring, twelve gold dots at 30° spacing, one central bindu. Reads as the months of the ritual year, the signs of the zodiac, the hours of the day — or simply *the full circle*. Use it as a **watermark**, never as the primary mark. The wordmark always wins.

Two files: `rtam-12-medallion-seal.svg` (the mark) and `rtam-12-medallion-pattern.svg` (a tileable field at lower opacity for certificate backgrounds and envelope interiors).

4 · COLOR

Seven tokens. Use them by name, not by hex. The CSS variables live in `brand/palette/colors.css`.

TOKEN	HEX	ROLE
<code>--rtam-gold</code>	<code>#C8A15A</code>	Antique gold. The bindu. Rules and accents.
<code>--rtam-ivory</code>	<code>#F7F3E9</code>	Warm ivory. The default ground.
<code>--rtam-charcoal</code>	<code>#1A1A1A</code>	Near-black. Body text and the wordmark on light grounds.
<code>--rtam-sandstone</code>	<code>#E6DED1</code>	Soft warm gray. Borders, dividers, panel chrome.
<code>--rtam-indigo</code>	<code>#1C1A3D</code>	Sacred-night indigo. Reserved for sacred / poster / cover surfaces.
<code>--rtam-bronze</code>	<code>#9B6A2F</code>	Deeper gold. Use sparingly for emphasis on ivory.
<code>--rtam-stone</code>	<code>#B8B1A4</code>	Quiet stone gray. Supporting copy that should not compete.

The wordmark must work in pure black. This is a non-negotiable reproduction test — every variant of the wordmark has been verified in pure `#1A1A1A` for fax, single-color print, and microform.

5 · TYPOGRAPHY

Three faces. Each does one job.

FACE	USE
Cinzel (400 / 500 / 600 / 700)	Display Latin. The wordmark, headlines, certificate citations, the brand's voice in public.
Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit (regular)	The sacred face. All Devanagari typesetting.
Inter (300 / 400 / 500 / 600)	Working sans. Body copy, captions, metadata, anything functional.

A printable font-installation note for vendors is in `brand/README.md`. SVG glyphs can be outlined in Inkscape (`Path → Object to Path`) or Illustrator (`Type → Create Outlines`) before being sent to a print shop that lacks the fonts.

6 · SPACING & CLEAR-SPACE

The wordmark gets a clear-space margin equal to the **cap-height of R** on every side. In the canonical 1080×240 viewBox that is ≈ 120 viewBox units. Nothing — image, fold, type, or border — may enter that zone.

The R-monogram (square icon) gets a clear-space margin equal to $\frac{1}{4}$ of its width. The Devanagari ऀ monogram uses the same rule.

Lockups inherit their wordmark's clear-space. The temple lockup additionally requires its full 1280-unit viewBox; do not crop or letter-space-reduce the temple name.

7 · DO & DON'T

Do

- Place the wordmark on ivory, charcoal, or sacred-night indigo.
- Use the bindu in every reproduction where it is legible (≥ 6 cm wide).
- Pair Cinzel with Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit; pair both with Inter for body.
- Treat the seal as a watermark.

Don't

- Don't move, resize, or recolor the bindu independently of the wordmark. Use a variant file instead.
- Don't substitute the Cinzel R with a different serif. The R's shape is part of the mark.
- Don't render the wordmark on a busy photographic background. Use the ivory, charcoal, or indigo ground.
- Don't outline, emboss, drop-shadow, or gradient the wordmark. The mark is flat. Always.
- Don't promote the seal above the wordmark. The wordmark is primary; the seal supports.
- Don't use the public RTAM (no-bindu) variant when the bindu would reproduce correctly. It exists only as a fallback.

8 · APPLICATIONS

The brand kit ships HTML mockups for the most common contexts. See `brand/previews/mockups/` (sources) and `brand/exports/mockups/` (rendered PNGs).

MOCKUP	USE
<code>website-header.html</code>	Web nav with wordmark + nav + Donate CTA.
<code>letterhead.html</code>	Trust correspondence, formal letters.
<code>donation-receipt.html</code>	Contribution receipts with 80G reference.
<code>donation-poster.html</code>	Annual renovation drive poster (1080×1350, sacred-night indigo).
<code>instagram-avatar.html</code>	Three avatar variants for social platforms.
<code>youtube-banner.html</code>	2560×1440 with explicit mobile-safe area.
<code>certificate.html</code>	Certificate of Contribution with watermark seal.
<code>favicon-scale-test.html</code>	Browser-tab favicon at 16–256 px.

9 · FILES AT A GLANCE

```
brand/
├─ palette/colors.{json,css}          # design tokens
├─ logos/rtam-wordmark-*.svg          # 5 wordmark variants
├─ icons/rtam-rdot-icon-*.svg         # 5 R-monogram variants
├─ icons/rtam-devanagari-ri-icon-*.svg # 4 ॠ monogram variants
├─ icons/favicon.svg                  # 32 viewBox favicon
├─ lockups/*.svg                      # 4 lockup compositions
├─ seal/*.svg                         # mark + tileable pattern
├─ previews/index.html                # master gallery
├─ previews/typography-specimen.html
├─ previews/{wordmark,monogram,devanagari-monogram,lockups,seal}-specimen.html
├─ previews/mockups/*.html            # 8 application mockups
├─ guidelines/brand-book.md           # this document
├─ guidelines/usage-rules.md          # quick reference
├─ tools/render_*.py                  # SVG→PNG, HTML→PNG/PDF, MD→PDF
└─ exports/{png,pdf,mockups}/         # rendered outputs
```

The work continues steadily, in keeping with the order it intends to serve.

— ऋतस्य पन्थाम्